

OFFICIAL TOURNAMENT DIRECTIVE

HACKATHON PREMIER LEAGUE 2026

Shri Madhwa Vadiraja Institute of Technology & Management (SMVITM), Bantakal

Registration: 2 – 6 September 2026 | Shortlist Kickoff: 8 September 2026



OFFICIAL RULE BOOK



SQUAD SPIRIT & CULTURE

3 WEEKS LEAGUE DURATION	3 PHASES BUILD • COMPETE • IMPROVE	5 MEMBERS EXACT TEAM SIZE	₹150 / ₹200 FEE (SHORTLISTED ONLY)
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01 ABOUT HPL

TOURNAMENT OVERVIEW

★ 3-week progressive tournament solving real-world challenges through technology.

- Hackathon Premier League (HPL) 2026 is a three-week hackathon organized by Shri Madhwa Vadiraja Institute of Technology and Management (SMVITM).
- HPL challenges students to develop innovative and practical solutions to real-world problems using modern technology.
- Participants will work in teams, propose their solutions during registration, and shortlisted teams will proceed to subsequent stages of the league.

02 ELIGIBILITY

PARTICIPATION CRITERIA

★ Open only to SMVITM students (Any branch: CS, ECE, MECH, AIDS, AIML, MBA; Any year 1-4).

- HPL 2026 is open exclusively to enrolled students of Shri Madhwa Vadiraja Institute of Technology and Management (SMVITM), Bantakal.
- Participants may belong to any academic year (1st, 2nd, 3rd, or 4th year) and any department.
- Inter-departmental and inter-year squad formation is strongly encouraged.

03 TEAM FORMATION**SQUAD ROSTER**

★ Exactly 5 members per squad. No changes allowed post-registration.

- Each team must consist of exactly 5 members — no more, no less.
- Teams may be formed freely by the participants across departments.
- A participant can be a member of only one team throughout HPL 2026.
- Teams are encouraged to maintain cross-functional balance (frontend, backend, design, AI/ML, presenting).
- The team composition cannot be changed once the registration form is submitted.
- Any correction or issue regarding registration details must be communicated directly to an HPL Coordinator.

04 REGISTRATION**ENTRY PROTOCOL**

★ Requires Team Name, Leader & 5 Members info, Selected PS, and 3-min Drive Video link.

- Registration Period: 2 September 2026 – 6 September 2026.
- Registration strictly closes at 11:59 PM on 6 September 2026.
- Each team must submit: Team Name, Team Leader Details (Name, Email, Contact), Names & Emails of all 5 members, Selected Problem Statement, and Solution Video (Google Drive Link).
- Teams may choose any one of the three official problem statements.
- IMPORTANT: The selected problem statement and squad composition are permanent after form submission.

05 PROBLEM STATEMENTS**CHALLENGE TRACKS**

★ These problem statements are exclusively for shortlisting. Actual Problem Statements will be released after shortlisting.

⚠ Important: This problem statements are only for shortlisting. Actual Problem Statements will be given after shortlisting.

- PS 01 — WeatherGPT: Conversational AI for Weather Forecasting, Alerts, and Climate Information (Key Focus: Weather forecasting, alerts, climate insights, conversational UX).
- PS 02 — Rural Market Intelligence: Data-driven platform empowering farmers with price trends, nearby mandi comparisons, and net revenue calculators (Key Focus: Price discovery, demand insights, supply chain transparency).
- PS 03 — Internship & Opportunity Aggregator: Platform aggregating internships, scholarships, and hackathons with intelligent preference matching and deadline tracking.
- All 3 Problem Statements are evaluated on 6 core pillars: Problem Understanding, Functionality, User Experience, Technical Implementation, Innovation, and Practicality.

06 REGISTRATION VIDEO**SUBMISSION VIDEO**

★ Max 3 mins, set Drive sharing to "Anyone with the link", name file as TeamName.

- Every team must submit a video demonstrating their proposed solution as part of registration.
- Video must cover: 1) Project Walkthrough, 2) Technology Stack, 3) Technology Justification, 4) Problem Solving Approach, 5) Uniqueness / Innovation.
- Maximum duration: 3 minutes (videos exceeding 3 minutes will be penalized).
- The video must be uploaded to Google Drive with sharing permission set to "Anyone with the link can view".
- The video file name must be your official Team Name.
- If the submitted video cannot be accessed, the HPL committee will reach out via email to resolve the permissions.

07 SHORTLISTING**EVALUATION PHASE**

★ Results published on 8 Sept 2026 followed by HPL Inauguration.

- All registered teams will undergo a rigorous shortlisting review by evaluation panels.
- The shortlisted teams will be officially announced on the HPL website on 8 September 2026.
- Further tournament stages, weekly match schedules, and milestones will be revealed during the HPL Inauguration ceremony.

**FAIR PLAY & ZERO TOLERANCE FOR PLAGIARISM**

All project repositories, commits, and demo videos are audited via AST similarity scans. Misconduct or copied commercial solutions result in immediate disqualification.

08 TECHNOLOGY & AI USAGE**TECH GUIDELINES**

★ Tech stack is 100% your choice. Generative AI tools are permitted.

- Technology Freedom: There are zero restrictions on technology stacks. Teams are free to choose languages, frameworks, libraries, cloud platforms, and APIs of their choice.
- AI Usage: Participants are permitted and encouraged to use modern AI tools, LLMs, copilot utilities, and AI APIs while engineering their solutions.

09 SHORTLISTED TEAM FEE

REGISTRATION FEE

★ Fee applies only after shortlisting: ₹150 (IEEE squad) / ₹200 (Non-IEEE squad).

- Zero fee at initial registration. The registration fee applies ONLY to teams that are shortlisted.
- Team with at least one active IEEE student member: ₹150 / team.
- Team with no IEEE student member: ₹200 / team.
- Payment links and instructions will be sent with the shortlist notification on 8 September 2026.

10 CANCELLATION & REFUND

FINANCE POLICY

★ Withdrawal is allowed anytime by informing coordinators; fees are non-refundable.

- Teams may cancel or withdraw their participation at any time by notifying an HPL Coordinator in writing.
- Once the shortlisted-team registration fee has been paid, it is strictly non-refundable under any circumstance.

11 CODE OF CONDUCT & FAIR PLAY

INTEGRITY

★ Submit original work. Disqualification applies for plagiarism or harassment.

- Submit original work and strictly avoid plagiarism or copying another squad's work.
- Do not access another team's source code, accounts, cloud infrastructure, or repositories without authorization.
- Do not intentionally disrupt, DDoS, or sabotage any team's demonstration or hardware.
- Maintain respectful, collaborative, and professional behaviour toward fellow participants, coordinators, mentors, and jury members.
- Harassment, bullying, or discriminatory conduct will result in immediate expulsion.
- Respect open-source licenses and attribution when integrating third-party dependencies.
- Any form of cheating or unfair practice will result in immediate disqualification. The organizing committee's decision is final.

12 IMPORTANT DATES

SCHEDULE

★ Mark 6 Sept (11:59 PM) for registration close & 8 Sept for shortlist + kickoff.

- 2 September 2026: Official Registrations Open.
- 6 September 2026 (11:59 PM): Registrations Strictly Close.
- 8 September 2026: Shortlisted Teams Announced on Portal.
- 8 September 2026: Official HPL 2026 Inauguration Ceremony.
- Subsequent Match Days & Grand Finale dates announced at Inauguration.

13 CERTIFICATES

RECOGNITION

★ Verified participation & merit certificates issued by SMVITM.

- Official Certificates of Participation will be issued to all eligible teams that complete scheduled match days.
- Certificates of Merit and Winner credentials will be awarded to Champions, Runners-Up, and Domain Toppers.

14 OFFICIAL COMMUNICATION

CHANNELS

★ Check the team leader and members' registered email IDs regularly.

- All official announcements, shortlists, match schedules, and directives are communicated via email.
- Participants are strictly responsible for regularly checking the email addresses provided during registration.

15 GENERAL RULES

CORE REGULATIONS

★ All data must be accurate. Committee decisions are binding and final.

- Participants must provide accurate, verified personal and college details during registration.
- Each participant can register with only one team.
- Each squad roster must have exactly 5 members.
- Selected problem statements and team rosters are locked permanently post-submission.
- Any urgent corrections must be escalated directly to an HPL Coordinator.
- Participants must adhere to all directives and guidelines issued by the HPL organizing committee throughout the league.